

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Rig Veda as source and chronological spine

FAMILY BOOKS (2-7) -> OTHER LAYERS (1, 8, 9, 10) -> REDACTION/ORAL PRESERVATION

earlier core trends varied/later material disciplined transmission



Working early Vedic horizon: broadly c. 1500-1000 BCE, not a date for every hymn.

Text gives a poetic-ritual world; frequency and silence are not census data.

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Sapta-Sindhu textual geography

NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU

Kabul/Kubha ---- Indus/Sindhu ---- Punjab rivers ---- Sarasvati/Drishadvati zone
mountain routes trunk river pastoral/farming eastern attention

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Rivers organise praise, movement, pasture and conflict; geography is selective.
Ganga is marginal in this horizon; later Vedic expansion shifts the centre east.
Do not turn remembered rivers into precise political borders.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Kin polity: authority without territorial state

KULA -> GRAMA -> VIS -> JANA

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RAJAN: war leadership, protection, distribution and ritual status; not absolute monarch

|-- sabha: smaller/select assembly context | samiti: broader assembly

|-- purohita: adviser | senani: martial role | gramani: group leader

+-> bali: offering/tribute, not a regular land-revenue bureaucracy

Power rested on kin support, cattle, gifts, assemblies and successful leadership.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Cattle-agriculture economy loop

PASTURE + WATER -> CATTLE WEALTH -> dairy, traction, gifts, status and conflict

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mixed farming: barley/yava + cultivation + crafts + exchange + household production

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mobility and raiding

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settlement and seasonal cropping

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Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Society: kinship, difference and projection limits

HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER


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Purusha Sukta is late in the corpus; later jati cannot be back-projected.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Deities, rita, yajna and soma

RITA: ordered truth and cosmic-social regularity

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DEITIES: Indra-war/rain | Agni-fire/mediator | Varuna-order | Soma-plant/deity

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YAJNA: praise + offering + priestly speech -> protection, cattle and victory

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Religion links ecology, warfare, gift economy and order; temples are not central.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Conflict, technology and cultural interaction

horse/chariot + bows/weapons + mobile war bands

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cattle raids + route/pasture contests + Dasharajna coalition conflict

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leadership and prestige

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contact and incorporation

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Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Early to Later Vedic transformation

EARLY VEDIC

north-west/Sapta-Sindhu
jana and kin leadership
cattle-centred mixed economy
fluid differentiation
deity praise and yajna

LATER VEDIC

upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement
janapada, stronger monarchy and ratnins
plough agriculture, surplus and crafts
firmer varna/patriarchy and gotra
royal ritual and Upanishadic questioning

VERDICT: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Rig Vedic answer architecture

10 MARKS: source caution -> institution/economy -> hymn term -> qualification

15 MARKS: geography -> polity -> economy -> society -> religion -> archaeology caution

20 MARKS: corpus/layers -> Sapta-Sindhu -> kin system -> cattle-agriculture loop
-> differentiation -> ritual worldview -> conflict/contact -> transition

AVOID: nomad-only, caste-complete, state/empire or homogeneous-date claims.

CLOSE: a layered pastoral-agricultural kin society undergoing differentiation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. Tie each claim to Rigvedic layer, genre, term cluster and oral transmission.
2. Treat archaeology as a correlation for settlement and technology, not language.
3. Use Later Vedic evidence only for explicit comparison, never backward projection.

VERDICT: The corpus gives strong patterns but not a census or exact institutional code.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Examiner traps and contested boundaries

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Pastoral predominance is not pure pastoralism; rajan is chief, not emperor.
2. Sabha, samiti and vidatha are not modern democratic parliaments.
3. Purusha Sukta is a later Book 10 articulation; ayas is not automatically iron.

VERDICT: Translate Sanskrit terms by context and state uncertainty.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Integrated answer spine and qualified conclusion

ANSWER SPINE

1. Route 2023 society/religion and 2026 wells, rivers and kshetra-patni.
2. Write source -> geography -> economy -> kin polity -> society -> religion.
3. End with gradual Early-to-Later change, continuity and regional variation.

VERDICT: Early Vedic society was mixed, stratifying and kin-ordered, not monolithic.